A-A-53447
29 April 1988

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

TOWEL PACK, SURGICAL

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this Commercial Item Description in place of Military Specification MIL-T-36916A.

This Commercial Item Description covers a sterile, disposable towel pack used for major and minor surgery.

Salient characteristics:

The surgical towel pack shall be a sterile, sealed pack containing four large disposable absorbent towels and one fabric outerwrap suitable for use in surgical operating rooms. Towels and outerwrap shall be made of non-woven fabric.

Towels shall be constructed of fully bleached pulp tissue bonded to nylon or rayon reinforcing yarns. Tissue of towels shall be approximately 40 pounds basis weight, which shall be in accordance with T-410 of TAPPI.

The following shall be additional physical characteristics of the towel:

Size: Minimum width - 19 inches
Minimum area - 494 square inches

The dimensions shall not vary more than 10 percent after sterilization.

Tensile Strength: Machine direction - 10.0 lbs per inch, minimum average.
Cross direction - 8.0 lbs per inch, minimum average.

Weight: 2.0 ounce per square yard, minimum

Hand of fabric: Machine direction - 35.0 grams, maximum average.

Cross direction - 35.0 grams, maximum average.

AMSC N/A FSC 6530

DISTRIBUTION STATEMENT A. Approved for public release; distribution is unlimited.

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Surface resistivity: 5 x 10" ohms/square inch at 50 percent relative humidity - maximum

Color: Pastel shades of blue, green, or grey.

Four towels shall be enclosed within a resin bonded, non-woven fabric outerwrap of 26 ±3 pounds basis weight and of sufficient size to permit optimum aseptic technique. The minimum tensile strength of the outerwrap fabric shall be 4.5 pounds per inch in the machine direction and 1.5 pounds per inch in the cross direction. The color of the outerwrap shall be white or pastel shades of blue, green, or grey.

The towels and outerwrap shall be functionally folded. The folded towels shall be clearly marked with the words "absorbent towel".

The towels and outerwrap shall be abrasion resistant and free of lint, objectionable noises when used, and objectionable odors. There shall be no irritating or toxic elements present in the finished fabric.

The components of the pack shall be enclosed in a sealed paper or plastic immediate container (bag) capable of maintaining sterility of contents until manually opened. The bag shall be designed with a tear open feature. Plastic bags shall have a wall thickness of not less than 3.5 mils. Contents enclosed in a paper bag shall be further packaged in a 3.5 mil anti-static plastic bag.

The components of the towel pack shall comply with conductivity testing requirements in paragraph 3-3.6.5 of National Fire Protection Association (NFPA) code pamphlet No. 99 Inhalation Anesthetics, and with the flame resistance requirements for class 3 of NFPA 702 Flammability of Wearing Apparel.

Labeling of the towel pack shall comply with the Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act.

The label of the container on which the National Stock Number (NSN) appears shall bear the following:

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a. Date of packaging (month and year, e.g. 5-87). Final sterilization shall be on or after indicated packaging date.

b. Method of sterilization (G for Gas, R for Radiation, S for Steam, D for Dry Heat Sterilization)

Workmanship. The surgical towel packs shall be free from defects which detract from their appearance or impair their serviceability.

Unit. Package (PG). One package containing 96 towels and 24 outerwraps, divided into 24 individually sterile sealed and labeled packs, each containing 4 towels and 1 outerwrap, as specified, constitutes one unit.

Quality Assurance Provisions.

Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of three years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

Inspection. Inspection, as used herein, is defined as both examination (such as visual or auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item.

Tests. Tests shall be conducted to determine compliance with specification requirements. Where feasible, the same sample shall be used for the determination of two or more test characteristics.

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Sampling for examination. Sampling for examination shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105, with an AQL of 1.0 (percent defective) and an inspection level of II. The unit of product for examination purposes shall be one surgical towel pack as specified in this description.

Defects.

COMPONENTS

Components not functionally folded.

Components not free of holes and tears.

Components not clean, not free from loose or harmful foreign matter.

Glued seam open or not properly sealed.

END ITEM

Any component missing or unusable.

Paper bag not properly sealed.

Plastic bag damaged.

Sampling for tests. Sampling for tests including dimensional test, shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105, with an AQL of 2.5 (percent defective) and inspection level of S-3. The unit of product for test purposes shall be one surgical towel pack.

Tests.

Sterility. Sterilization testing shall be in accordance with the FDA's current Guideline on General Principles of Process Validation.

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Contractor certification. The contractor shall certify that the product offered meets the salient characteristics of this description and conforms to the producers' own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

Regulatory requirements.

Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act. If the product covered by this document has been determined by the U.S. Food and Drug Administration to be under its jurisdiction, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of the Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act, as amended, and regulations promulgated thereunder. In addition, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of all other applicable Federal, State, and local statutes, ordinances, and regulations.

Recovered materials. The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered material in accordance with Public Law 94-580, as amended, and as implemented by Federal Acquisition Regulation Subpart 23.4 to the maximum extent practical.

Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking. Unless otherwise specified, preservation, packaging, and packing shall be to a degree of protection to preclude damage to containers and/or contents thereof under normal shipping conditions, handling, etc., involving shipment from the supply source to the receiving activity, plus reshipment from receiving activity, and shall conform to applicable carrier's rules and regulations. Intermediate and exterior package quantities and labeling and marking shall be as specified in the contract and/or order.

NOTE: The following National Stock Number is covered by this document:

6530-00-110-1854

Ordering data. Intermediate/exterior package quantities, labeling, and marking must be specified in the contract and/or order.

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MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians:

Army - MD
Navy - MS
Air Force - 03

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

DoD - MB

Agent:

DLA-DM

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

VA-OSS
PHS
FDA-MPQAS

Project No. 6530-1964

PGC 49989

Location: CID/TOWEL/H13-28

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NOTE This form may not be used to request copies of documents, nor to request waivers, deviations, or clarification of specification requirements on current contracts. Comments submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document(s) or to amend contractual requirements.

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

(See Instructions – Reverse Side)

1. DOCUMENT NUMBER	2. DOCUMENT TITLE
A-A-53347	TOWEL PACK, SURGICAL

3a. NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION	4. TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)*
	☐ VENDOR
	☐ USER
b. ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)*	☐ MANUFACTURER
	☐ OTHER *(Specify)*: _____

5. PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording

b. Recommended Wording

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation

6. REMARKS

7a. NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last, First, MI)* – Optional	b. WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* – Optional
c. MAILING ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)* – Optional	8. DATE OF SUBMISSION *(YYMMDD)*

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